

Belinda Z. Li

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Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2020 –

PhD student, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

- Advisor: Jacob Andreas

University of Washington

2015 – 2019

Bachelors of Science, Computer Science, Magna Cum Laude

- Cumulative GPA: 3.95 / 4.0, Major GPA: 3.96 / 4.0
- Highlighted Coursework: Natural Language Processing, NLP Capstone, Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Algorithms, Databases, Operating Systems, Distributed Systems, Security, Foundations of Computing I/II, Organic Chemistry I/II/III, General Chemistry I/II/III, Biology I/II/III, Honors Accelerated Calculus I/II/III
- Advisor: Luke Zettlemoyer

Robinson Center for Young Scholars – Transition School/Early Entrance Program

2014 – 2015

GED Equivalent

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- [1] **Belinda Z. Li**, Sewon Min, Srini Iyer, Yashar Mehdad, and Wen-tau Yih. “[Efficient One-Pass End-to-End Entity Linking for Questions](#)”. In: *Proceedings of the 2020 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. Association for Computational Linguistics, Nov. 2020.
- [2] Nayeon Lee, **Belinda Z. Li**, Sinong Wang, Wen-tau Yih, Hao Ma, and Madian Khabsa. “[Language Models as Fact Checkers?](#)” In: *Proceedings of the Third Workshop on Fact Extraction and VERification (FEVER)*. Association for Computational Linguistics, July 2020, pp. 36–41.
- [3] **Belinda Z. Li**, Gabriel Stanovsky, and Luke Zettlemoyer. “[Active Learning for Coreference Resolution using Discrete Annotation](#)”. In: *Proceedings of the 58th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics*. Association for Computational Linguistics, July 2020, pp. 8320–8331.

Preprints

- [4] Sinong Wang, **Belinda Z. Li**, Madian Khabsa, Han Fang, and Hao Ma. [Linformer: Self-Attention with Linear Complexity](#). 2020. arXiv: [2006.04768](https://arxiv.org/abs/2006.04768) [cs.LG].

Research/Industry Experience

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Sep. 2020 –

Research Assistant, with Jacob Andreas

Facebook AI

Aug. 2019 – Sep. 2020

Software Engineer, AI Integrity Team (Facebook AI Applied Research)

- (Product) Built multi-lingual, multi-modal (image + text) representations for Facebook posts, pre-trained with self-supervision on Facebook data. Shipped to hate speech domain, improving offline hate speech prevalence metrics by 25%. (3rd most important hate-speech model in the ensemble meta-classifier used in production).
 - Work featured in part of this post: <https://ai.facebook.com/blog/ai-advances-to-better-detect-hate-speech/>
- (Research) Worked on entity linking for questions [1], fake news detection [2], model (Transformer) efficiency [4], and meta-learning for pre-training.
- (Mentorship) Co-mentored two PhD interns on the team.

University of Washington

Jan. 2018 – June 2019

Undergraduate Research Assistant, with Luke Zettlemoyer

- Active learning for coreference resolution [3]

- Entity-to-entity sentiment analysis using RNNs

Facebook

June 2018 – Aug. 2018

Software Engineer Intern, Bot Detection Team

- Worked on front-end script for tracking and storing user mouse movements
- Built a visualizer for the mouse movements
- Classified mouse movements for bot detection, using both heuristic techniques, as well as simple ML models (gradient boosting tree classifiers, K-means clustering)

University of Washington

June 2016 – Aug. 2016

Undergraduate Research Assistant, UW Biological Structures

- Created MATLAB program for triangulating locations of cell vesicles from 2D images

Teaching & Mentorship

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Sep. 2020 –

Undergraduate Research (UROP) Mentor

- Mentee: Nitya Parthasarathy
Project: tracing toxic language model outputs back to their source training examples.

University of Washington

Sep. 2017 – June 2019

Teaching Assistant

- Responsibilities include grading, leading weekly section, hosting office hours and review sessions, and weekly meetings with course staff. List of courses below:

CSE 311: Foundations of Computing I (Discrete Math), <i>with Kevin Zatloukal</i>	Spring 2019
CSE 312: Foundations of Computing II (Probability/Statistics), <i>with Martin Tompa</i>	Winter 2019
CSE 312: Foundations of Computing II (Probability/Statistics), <i>with Martin Tompa</i>	Winter 2018
CSE 331: Software Design and Implementation, <i>with Kevin Zatloukal</i>	Autumn 2017

Robinson Center for Young Scholars

2015 – 2016

Early Entrance Program / Transition School Mentor

- Meeting regularly with and guiding an assigned Transition School student (Angela Sun)

Awards

Academic

Ida M. Green Memorial Fellowship

2020 – 2021

ACL Student Scholarship

2020

Denice Dee Denton Scholars Endowment

2018 – 2019

Dean's List

2015 – 2017 (annual), SP18/F18/SP19 (quarterly)
(every eligible quarter)

National Merit Scholar

2016

Miscellany

Dance: Overseas Taoli Cup Dance Competition Gold Medal (2016); C Dream Performing Arts Scholarship (2016)

Piano: ABRSM Grade 8 Piano Pass with Distinction (2016, *scored highest score category in highest pre-collegiate level*); Eastside Music Teachers' Association Scholarship Competition, 1st place (2014/2015/2016, *3-time champion*)

Service

Program Committee (Reviewer): EMNLP 2020, COLING 2020

Student Volunteer/Scholarship: ACL 2020